

Team Tree

A football story for understanding how plants help rainwater soak into the ground instead of racing away downhill.



THE AIM

Get the rain into the ground, where it can feed soil, plants, streams and springs later.

THE DANGER

On bare compacted ground, rain runs off the pitch before it gets a chance to score.

The Team

Leaves defend

Leaves and branches slow the rain, soften the impact, and stop soil being smashed by hard drops.

Stems control midfield

Stems and trunks guide water down more calmly, turning a fast attack into controlled play.

Roots attack

Roots make channels and spaces in the soil. They create the chances for water to score underground.

Soil life coaches

Worms, fungi, insects and microbes build better soil structure. They help the whole team perform.

Healthy soil is the goal

The goal is water soaking in, not running away. A good soil goal holds water and releases it slowly.

Bare ground loses possession

Compacted bare ground has no defence. Water runs fast, takes soil with it, and leaves the field.

Humans Are the Manager

The manager cannot kick every ball. Their job is to choose the team shape: where to plant, where to protect young trees, where to keep animals off while roots grow, and where to watch what happens after rain.

Field Challenge

Stand on a slope after rain and ask:

- Where is water running away fastest?
- Where is the ground bare, hard or compacted?
- Where are trees, roots or rough grass already slowing water down?
- Where would you put your next defender?

Rain is the ball. Leaves defend. Roots attack. Soil is the goal. Humans manage the team.

Prepared as a simple water-education handout for the Tump Farm spring recharge discussion.